

Beyond Wealth: Building a Lasting Legacy



■ **Dr. Payal Bansal Kanodia**
Chairperson - M3M Foundation

Highlights

- An heiress to one of India's leading real estate enterprises, Dr. Payal Bansal Kanodia belongs to a family synonymous with visionary wealth creation and large-scale institution building. Yet, she has consciously chosen to transform privilege into purpose, emerging as one of India's most influential voices in philanthropy, sustainability, and inclusive development.
- M3M Foundation topped the real estate sector and led Gurugram's giving on the EdelGive-Hurun India Philanthropy List

2025 with a social investment of ₹70 crore.

- Dr. Payal Bansal Kanodia is among the Top 5 Wealthiest Individuals in Real Estate (India)
- Networth: 2 Billion (USD)

Key Philanthropy Details

- Total Contribution: Invested ₹70 crore in social development initiatives during FY 2024–25.
- Sector Rank: Ranked No. 1 in the real estate sector across India.
- Local Rank: Ranked No. 1 in Gurugram, contributing 78% of the city's total

philanthropic giving.

- National Standing: Placed 7th in the ₹50 crore to ₹100 crore donor category and 25th overall.

What did you see that others missed, and how did you turn that insight into a product or business?

I have always believed that the greatest opportunities are rarely hidden in markets; they are hidden in problems that society has quietly learnt to live with. Very early in my journey, I realised that philanthropy often addresses symptoms rather than systems. We celebrate the number of beneficiaries reached, but seldom ask whether those beneficiaries eventually become independent of our support. That, for me, was the blind spot. I saw that lasting transformation does not come from distributing resources—it comes from creating pathways of opportunity. Whether it is a woman acquiring employable skills through **Kaushal Sambal**, a young athlete pursuing excellence through **Lakshya**, a child entering the formal education system through **Saakshar**, or a farmer finding dignity through climate-resilient livelihoods, the objective has never been assistance for its own sake. It has always been empowerment that culminates in **Aatmanirbharta**.

The same philosophy informed our environmental work. Many organisations measure success by the number of trees planted. We chose instead to ask a more consequential question: *Who will care for these trees ten years from now?* That single insight transformed **Sankalp** from a plantation drive into a community-owned movement, where families dedicate trees to their children and villages become custodians of their own ecological future. Likewise, through **VanJeevan**, we recognised that human-wildlife conflict was not simply a conservation issue but an ecosystem